AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A230A
Reading and Studying Literature I
MTA
BRANCHES MAIN
KSA Makeup
2025-2026/First Semester
Date: 15 Nov. 2025
5:00 – 7:00

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **2 hours**

1. The duration of the exam is 2 hours.
2. Part I answers should be specific. The word count should be within the range of words.
3. Part II answers should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis in introduction, develop a critical discussion in the body paragraphs, provide specific appropriate examples, then end with a conclusion. Analyze and discuss exam thoroughly and define all important terms. Refer to relevant critical theory to support argument.
4. The word count for the essay should be within the range of 350 words.
5. Pay attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
6. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.

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Section I: Short Answer Questions. (15 marks)

A. Choose ANY TWO of the following to answer in a short passage of about 150 words. (7.5 marks each)

1. Samuel Coleridge described Iago's behavior as 'the motive-hunting of a motiveless malignity.' Discuss what this phrase reveals about Coleridge's interpretation of Iago's character.

2. What is meant by 'dystopian literature'? Does Voltaire's *Candide* contain dystopian themes? Discuss.

3. In *The Duchess of Malfi*, how does Antonio's opening speech about courts (the French and the Italian) reveal his moral vision and our understanding of his character?

Section II: Essay Questions. (15 marks)

Choose ONE of the following questions to answer. Develop an essay of 350 words.

1. In Voltaire's *Candide* the protagonist encounters various forms of injustice throughout his journey. Reflect on the statement below and discuss how it relates to the experiences of Candide and two other characters throughout the text. Provide specific examples from the text to support your discussion.

   "All is for the best, in the best of all possible worlds."

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2. With reference to the lines below from Shakespeare's *Othello*, how does this exchange between Iago and Othello reveal Iago's insinuations and Othello's shifting psychological state? Analyze the lines and consider the power dynamics and who controls the conversation. How does this excerpt foreshadow Othello's later development?

OTHELLO:
O, yes; and went between us very oft.
IAGO:
Indeed!
OTHELLO:
Indeed! ay, indeed: discern'st thou aught in that?
Is he not honest?
IAGO:
Honest, my lord!
OTHELLO:
Honest! ay, honest.
IAGO:
My lord, for aught I know.
OTHELLO:
What dost thou think?
IAGO:
Think, my lord!
OTHELLO:
Think, my lord!
By heaven, he echoes me,
As if there were some monster in his thought
Too hideous to be shown.

END OF QUESTIONS

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